WINDOWS 10 / 11 - PRINTABLE TASK CHECKLIST

175 tasks | Use each box for one completed check, fix or verification

Round/date: _____ Team: _____

Image: _____ Starting score: _____ Final: _____

Write N/A beside items that do not apply. Follow the original Windows guide before any change.

01. Read the image instructions and prepare safely

- ☐ **W001** Read the complete image README before making any change N/A
- ☐ **W002** Record the current Windows version, edition and build N/A
- ☐ **W003** Record the initial scoring report value and timestamp N/A
- ☐ **W004** Write down all required user accounts N/A
- ☐ **W005** Write down all required local administrators N/A
- ☐ **W006** Identify any domain membership or centrally managed policies N/A
- ☐ **W007** List README-required services and applications N/A
- ☐ **W008** List prohibited applications, files and remote-access tools N/A
- ☐ **W009** Identify required network shares and their authorized users N/A
- ☐ **W010** Identify required network services and listening ports N/A
- ☐ **W011** Confirm the current administrator can elevate successfully N/A
- ☐ **W012** Record a VM recovery method or approved snapshot if allowed N/A
- ☐ **W013** Open an elevated PowerShell window N/A
- ☐ **W014** Record every changed setting and its original value N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

02. Forensic questions and evidence

- ☐ **W015** Find every Forensics Question file supplied with the image N/A
- ☐ **W016** Read each complete question and required answer format N/A
- ☐ **W017** Locate the relevant user, file, program, event or configuration N/A
- ☐ **W018** Record suspicious-file paths before any cleanup N/A
- ☐ **W019** Record file hash when the question requests one N/A
- ☐ **W020** Record timestamps and time zone when requested N/A

- [ ] **W021** Inspect relevant Event Viewer logs without clearing them N/A
- [ ] **W022** Decode requested text only as data; never execute it N/A
- [ ] **W023** Save each answer in the original question file N/A
- [ ] **W024** Confirm every question file was saved N/A
- [ ] **W025** Reopen unanswered questions after other safe investigations N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

03. Users, Guest account and administrators

- [ ] **W026** List all local users, including disabled and built-in accounts N/A
- [ ] **W027** Compare human users with the README authorization list N/A
- [ ] **W028** Inspect built-in Guest account state N/A
- [ ] **W029** Inspect built-in Administrator account and recovery requirements N/A
- [ ] **W030** Inspect local Administrators group membership N/A
- [ ] **W031** Inspect Remote Desktop Users group membership N/A
- [ ] **W032** Inspect Backup Operators and any other privileged local groups N/A
- [ ] **W033** Identify domain groups that legitimately administer this workstation N/A
- [ ] **W034** Check PasswordRequired and PasswordNeverExpires for each real user N/A
- [ ] **W035** Check each authorized user’s Enabled state N/A
- [ ] **W036** Disable a confirmed unauthorized user only after preserving evidence N/A
- [ ] **W037** Remove confirmed unauthorized local administrator membership N/A
- [ ] **W038** Add a missing authorized user only if the README requires it N/A
- [ ] **W039** Restore missing authorized administrator membership if needed N/A
- [ ] **W040** Set a required user’s password interactively if policy requires it N/A
- [ ] **W041** Verify local user and privileged-group membership after changes N/A
- [ ] **W042** Test a second authorized administrator sign-in N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

04. Passwords, lockout and effective policy

- [ ] **W043** Record current local account password policy with net accounts N/A
- [ ] **W044** Inspect minimum password length N/A
- [ ] **W045** Inspect maximum password age N/A

- [ ] **W046** Inspect minimum password age N/A
- [ ] **W047** Inspect password history requirement N/A
- [ ] **W048** Inspect complexity requirement N/A
- [ ] **W049** Inspect reversible encryption setting N/A
- [ ] **W050** Inspect account lockout threshold N/A
- [ ] **W051** Inspect account lockout duration N/A
- [ ] **W052** Inspect account lockout observation window N/A
- [ ] **W053** Check whether Group Policy overrides local settings N/A
- [ ] **W054** Back up current policy values before editing N/A
- [ ] **W055** Change only values actually required by the image N/A
- [ ] **W056** Verify final account policy with net accounts and policy GUI N/A
- [ ] **W057** Test an authorized normal-user login after policy changes N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

05. Defender and endpoint protection

- [ ] **W058** Identify which antivirus provider is active N/A
- [ ] **W059** Check Microsoft Defender antivirus and real-time protection state N/A
- [ ] **W060** Check behavior monitoring state N/A
- [ ] **W061** Check script scanning state N/A
- [ ] **W062** Check cloud-delivered protection when available N/A
- [ ] **W063** Check potentially unwanted application protection N/A
- [ ] **W064** Inspect Defender exclusion paths N/A
- [ ] **W065** Inspect Defender excluded file extensions N/A
- [ ] **W066** Inspect Defender excluded processes N/A
- [ ] **W067** Review exclusions against required applications before removal N/A
- [ ] **W068** Check current Defender signature date N/A
- [ ] **W069** Update signatures when required and supported N/A
- [ ] **W070** Review protection history and relevant detections N/A
- [ ] **W071** Perform an approved scan after collecting forensic evidence N/A
- [ ] **W072** Verify protection state and required software still work N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

06. Firewall and network exposure

- [ ] **W073** Check Domain firewall profile Enabled state N/A
- [ ] **W074** Check Private firewall profile Enabled state N/A
- [ ] **W075** Check Public firewall profile Enabled state N/A
- [ ] **W076** Check default inbound and outbound actions N/A
- [ ] **W077** Identify the currently active network profile N/A
- [ ] **W078** Inventory enabled inbound allow rules N/A
- [ ] **W079** Inspect suspicious rules for executable and port scope N/A
- [ ] **W080** Inspect remote IP scope of required inbound rules N/A
- [ ] **W081** List listening TCP ports and their owning processes N/A
- [ ] **W082** List listening UDP endpoints where needed N/A
- [ ] **W083** Record or export existing firewall policy before risky changes N/A
- [ ] **W084** Enable appropriate profiles only after required exceptions are safe N/A
- [ ] **W085** Disable only confirmed unauthorized inbound rules N/A
- [ ] **W086** Test every README-required network function from an approved client N/A
- [ ] **W087** Verify firewall state and record any rollback needed N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

07. Updates and Windows features

- [ ] **W088** Open Windows Update and inspect pending updates N/A
- [ ] **W089** Check Windows Update service configuration N/A
- [ ] **W090** Check whether updates are managed by domain policy N/A
- [ ] **W091** Inspect update history and any failed security updates N/A
- [ ] **W092** Install permitted security updates without forced release upgrade N/A
- [ ] **W093** Update required applications and browsers from approved sources N/A
- [ ] **W094** Check whether a restart is pending N/A
- [ ] **W095** Verify required applications still work after updates N/A
- [ ] **W096** Inspect SMBv1 optional feature state N/A
- [ ] **W097** Inspect SMB client signing requirement N/A
- [ ] **W098** Inspect SMB server signing requirement N/A

- [ ] **W099** Review legacy Telnet, TFTP, SNMP and PowerShell 2.0 components N/A
- [ ] **W100** Disable an unnecessary legacy feature only if compatible N/A
- [ ] **W101** Verify disabled feature state and any reboot requirement N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

08. Services, remote access and sharing

- [ ] **W102** Inventory installed services and startup types N/A
- [ ] **W103** Map unexpected service executables to actual file paths N/A
- [ ] **W104** Check Remote Registry state and whether it is required N/A
- [ ] **W105** Check Remote Desktop state and whether it is required N/A
- [ ] **W106** Check Network Level Authentication if RDP is required N/A
- [ ] **W107** Review authorized Remote Desktop Users membership N/A
- [ ] **W108** Check Remote Assistance policy and any required exception N/A
- [ ] **W109** Check SSH server or other remote-control services N/A
- [ ] **W110** Check required web, file, database or backup services N/A
- [ ] **W111** Check SMB share names and underlying folder paths N/A
- [ ] **W112** Check each required share’s share permissions N/A
- [ ] **W113** Check each required share’s NTFS permissions N/A
- [ ] **W114** Test file access as an authorized nonadministrator N/A
- [ ] **W115** Disable a confirmed unnecessary service one at a time N/A
- [ ] **W116** Verify remaining required services still function N/A
- [ ] **W117** Restore any required service accidentally disabled N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

09. Prohibited software, files and browser security

- [ ] **W118** Inspect installed desktop programs and app packages N/A
- [ ] **W119** Inspect Microsoft Store apps when relevant N/A
- [ ] **W120** Inspect portable utilities not registered as installed programs N/A
- [ ] **W121** Compare remote-control and networking tools with README N/A
- [ ] **W122** Identify prohibited games or torrent clients N/A
- [ ] **W123** Preview or review uninstall effects before removing software N/A

- [ ] **W124** Locate potentially prohibited media files without bulk deletion N/A
- [ ] **W125** Preserve files involved in forensic questions N/A
- [ ] **W126** Check browser version and permitted extensions N/A
- [ ] **W127** Check SmartScreen and suspicious download warnings N/A
- [ ] **W128** Check AutoPlay or automatic removable-media actions N/A
- [ ] **W129** Verify approved browsers and apps still launch N/A
- [ ] **W130** Confirm prohibited items were handled without affecting needed apps N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

10. Startup persistence and malicious changes

- [ ] **W131** Inspect Startup apps for unknown executables N/A
- [ ] **W132** Inspect HKLM Run startup registry entries N/A
- [ ] **W133** Inspect HKCU Run startup registry entries N/A
- [ ] **W134** Inspect scheduled tasks and task actions N/A
- [ ] **W135** Inspect newly installed or suspicious services N/A
- [ ] **W136** Inspect service Log On As identities N/A
- [ ] **W137** Check unexpected executables in AppData or Temp N/A
- [ ] **W138** Inspect hosts-file changes and required entries N/A
- [ ] **W139** Inspect unexpected listening ports or remote connections N/A
- [ ] **W140** Check suspicious executable hash and signature N/A
- [ ] **W141** Inspect Sticky Keys or accessibility-program replacement indicators N/A
- [ ] **W142** Correlate suspicious entries with event logs N/A
- [ ] **W143** Disable only confirmed unauthorized persistence after preserving evidence N/A
- [ ] **W144** Verify suspicious startup item no longer runs N/A
- [ ] **W145** Retest required logins and applications N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

11. Audit, user rights and advanced safeguards

- [ ] **W146** Inspect current audit policy categories N/A
- [ ] **W147** Check account logon auditing where required N/A
- [ ] **W148** Check account management auditing where required N/A

- [ ] **W149** Check logon and logoff auditing where required N/A
- [ ] **W150** Check policy-change auditing where required N/A
- [ ] **W151** Check process creation auditing if required N/A
- [ ] **W152** Inspect User Account Control enabled state N/A
- [ ] **W153** Inspect security options for guest and anonymous access N/A
- [ ] **W154** Inspect interactive logon and inactivity settings N/A
- [ ] **W155** Inspect user rights for privileged groups N/A
- [ ] **W156** Inspect effective Group Policy precedence N/A
- [ ] **W157** Inspect SMB signing and NTLM compatibility before changes N/A
- [ ] **W158** Inspect screen lock and resume authentication N/A
- [ ] **W159** Inspect WDigest plaintext-credential policy where relevant N/A
- [ ] **W160** Inspect LLMNR and NetBIOS policy only if role-compatible N/A
- [ ] **W161** Verify new audit events appear when auditing is enabled N/A
- [ ] **W162** Restore exact recorded policy if access breaks N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

12. Final verification and handoff

- [ ] **W163** Reopen and save all forensic answer files N/A
- [ ] **W164** Recheck the complete authorized user and admin list N/A
- [ ] **W165** Verify strong password and lockout policy matches README N/A
- [ ] **W166** Verify Defender status and signature freshness N/A
- [ ] **W167** Verify all applicable firewall profiles are on N/A
- [ ] **W168** Verify only necessary inbound exceptions remain N/A
- [ ] **W169** Verify updates are complete or pending status documented N/A
- [ ] **W170** Verify required services, shares and web connections work N/A
- [ ] **W171** Verify no unauthorized software or persistence remains N/A
- [ ] **W172** Confirm administrator and ordinary user logins still work N/A
- [ ] **W173** Refresh scoring report and record final value and time N/A
- [ ] **W174** Review each change and its rollback note N/A
- [ ] **W175** Save any permitted evidence and cleanly finish without unsafe reboot N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

FINAL REVIEW - required services tested / exceptions / reviewer:

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